

The Last Library

A Reflection on Making

Why I Built This

I built *The Last Library* because I wanted to make something small and quiet in a semester that often asked for big and loud. Most games are about doing — solving, fighting, winning. I wanted to make a game about **noticing**. About the kind of attention that doesn't get rewarded anywhere else: the kind you give to a room, a book, a candle, a sleeping cat.

Why This Story

The story came from thinking about places that are disappearing — old libraries, quiet neighborhoods, rooms nobody visits anymore. I kept returning to the idea that these places might be waiting for someone, and that the simple act of paying attention could matter to them. The library in the game is half-forgotten, but it is not dead. It just needs someone to listen to it before the last candle goes out. I wanted to write something tender about that — about the people and places we almost lose, and the small choice of staying with them a little longer.

What I Wanted Players to Feel

I wanted players to slow down. To feel a little lonely, a little curious, and then a little less lonely by the end. I did not want them to feel clever for solving something — I wanted them to feel **seen** by the game, the way the library notices them back. If a player finished the game and sat with it for a moment before closing the tab, I would consider that a success.

Why Twine and Bitsy

I chose **Twine and Bitsy together** because I wanted the game to have two different textures of memory. Twine holds the voice of the narrator — the framing, the road to the library, the choice at the end — because text carries reflection well. Bitsy holds the library itself — a small, walkable, pixel-sized place where you can stand next to a bookshelf and hear it speak. Bitsy has a handmade, almost childlike quality that felt right for a story about something fragile. Layering them let me move between *reflection and presence* — between reading about a place and being inside it. Neither tool alone could have held the whole feeling, but together they made the kind of small, quiet game I was hoping to build.

